

36 more vehicles a day?

The National Statistics Office's Q1 2026 release, tested against its own table

THE CLAIM

“...the stock of licensed motor vehicles increased at a net average rate of 36 motor vehicles per day.”

National Statistics Office, Motor Vehicles: Q1/2026, 13 May 2026

The same release gives the stock at the end of March 2026 as 460,648.

We rebuilt the figures from the NSO's Table 1 and its stated formula.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

Both figures reproduce exactly from the NSO's own table.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

460,648

Vehicles, end of March 2026

NSO Table 1. The vehicle categories add up to the total in all 13 quarters.

+3,245

Net rise in the quarter

460,648 minus 457,403 over 90 days is 36.06 a day, the NSO's formula.

63

Newly licensed a day (gross)

5,680 new licences. 6,963 vehicles went off the road and 4,140 returned; 36 is what is left.

35

The Commission's figure

Its 2026 Country Report says 35 a day; Q4 2025 gives 35.5 from the same table.

8 to 9

Daily rise in early 2024

The pace is recent: 36 a day is typical of the last four quarters, not of 2024.

FAIR TO SAY

The figures are right and described as net. The two NSO methods differ by 388 vehicles (0.08% of the stock) in the quarter, which the release attributes to database cut-off dates.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ NSO: confirm no revision to Q1 2026.

☐ NSO: the Q4 2025 release behind the Commission's 35.

☐ Transport Malta: why 2024 growth was so low.